

URIEL CRUZ

Senior Technical Designer — Unreal Engine 5

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Technical Designer specialized in Unreal Engine 5 (C++, Blueprints, GAS), currently driving technical design at GRIP Studios with full feature ownership of core player mechanics, 3C systems, and interactive gameplay features across AA and AAA projects. Proven track record leading engine migrations, designing multi-phase boss encounters (Tomb Raider: Legacy of Atlantis), and authoring modular gameplay architecture (TDDs) for studio-wide adoption.

Core Focus: Feature Ownership • 3Cs & Player Mechanics • Boss & Combat Design • UE5 Architecture

CORE SKILLS

Engines: Unreal Engine 4/5, Unity

Programming: C++, C#, Blueprints, Python, Java, SQL

Key Technologies: Gameplay Ability System (GAS), Motion Matching, AI Behavior Trees, Physics Simulation

Design: Combat & Boss Design, Technical Level Design, Modular System Architecture, Data-Driven Design

Tools: Perforce, Git, Jira, RenderDoc, Profiling Tools

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Technical Designer (UE5) | GRIP Studios Apr 2026 – Present

Projects: Unannounced Projects | UE5, C++, Blueprints, GAS, Perforce

- Spearhead technical design for primary 3C systems, player mechanics, and interactive features from concept to production.
- Author comprehensive Technical Design Documents (TDDs) and build modular, scalable gameplay frameworks.
- Partner with lead designers, animation, and engineering to align technical execution with game vision.

Technical Designer (UE5) | GRIP Studios Apr 2025 – Mar 2026

Projects: Tomb Raider: Legacy of Atlantis, Unannounced AAA Title | UE5, C++, Blueprints, GAS, Perforce

- Designed and scripted complex multi-phase boss fights and enemy AI logic in Tomb Raider: Legacy of Atlantis using C++ and Blueprints.
- Developed high-fidelity gameplay prototypes for combat, movement, and weapon systems across AAA unannounced titles.
- Debugged and optimized gameplay systems for target performance (60+ FPS), authoring reusable TDDs for studio-wide adoption.

Technical Designer (UE5) | DALOAR Studios Dec 2023 – Dec 2024

Projects: Unannounced AAA Title, The Occultist (Support) | UE5, C++, GAS, Motion Matching

- Architected a production-ready Motion Matching system and a universal context-aware parkour system (climbing, mantling, vaulting).
- Built a modular ability framework using the Gameplay Ability System (GAS), fully replicated for networked gameplay.
- Developed a data-driven movement framework allowing designers to configure abilities via Data Assets.
- Provided technical design support and GAS expertise across projects, including The Occultist.

Unreal Engine Developer (Lead Technical Designer) | HechicerIA Jan 2022 – Mar 2023

Project: Current Anima | UE5, Unity, C++, Blueprints

- Led the full technical migration of Current Anima from Unity to Unreal Engine 5, establishing new production pipelines, coding standards, and Perforce workflows.
- Trained and mentored the development team on UE5 best practices, Blueprint/C++ architecture, and plugin integration.

Technical Designer (Unreal Engine) | ORENJI GAMES SL Nov 2022 – Jun 2023

Project: Tears of Elara | UE5, Blueprints, C++

- Developed Blueprint/C++ interaction systems, state-based AI, level scripting, and editor utilities to streamline designer workflows.
- Implemented core combat mechanics, progression systems, and UI integration for Tears of Elara.

Software Developer | Everis (NTT DATA) *Oct 2019 – Jun 2020*

- Delivered backend development, testing, and incident resolution for enterprise-level systems using Java, SQL, and XML.

Web Developer | Verkia *Mar 2019 – Jun 2019*

- Designed, developed, and tested full-stack web applications.

EDUCATION

Master in Video Game Programming (Unreal Engine & C++) — Tokio School (2020 – 2022)

Advanced Course in Video Game Design — Tokio School (2020 – 2022)

Senior Technician in Multiplatform Application Development — IES Poeta Paco Mollà (2017 – 2019)

Higher Technician in Sociocultural and Tourist Animation — CIPFP Valle de Elda (2020 – 2022)

Java FullStack and Angular Course — Industrial Organization School (2019)

LANGUAGES

English: Full Professional Proficiency

Spanish: Native